

months or so, and not once has he been tested by the short delivery early on.

With a South African fast bowler, Morne Morkel, as the bowling coach, who used the bouncer very well, one would have thought that the bouncer would be a weapon unleashed at Head.

The first day's play being restricted because of rain also brought to attention the fact that the covers need to be used for the entire ground and not just the square where the pitch is. Once the covers are used for the ground, then play can resume pretty quickly after the rain stops.

Yes, there may be some time taken to remove the entire ground cover, but that is better than having play abandoned because of a wet outfield. That is unfair to the crowds who pay good money to come and watch some cricket.

That first day in Brisbane, with play being abandoned before 15 overs were completed, meant that the crowd got a refund of its money, so wouldn't the ground authorities like for play to resume as quickly as possible so they don't have to issue any refunds?

Covering the entire ground in today's day and age is absolutely necessary because, even the broadcasters, who pay humongous amounts to acquire the rights, also want more play to happen and not resort to showing highlights of old games again and again.

There's of course the cost factor for the cricket associations, but with the funds that are now available to them, investing in full ground covers is a must.

The Indian top-order has found it heavy going against this top-class, varied Australian attack. On these Australian pitches, it is never easy while the ball is hard and new, and that's why they have to be a little circumspect, at least at the start of their innings.

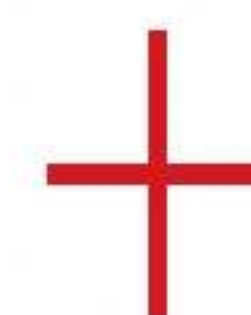
If they can take a leaf out of the way Smith, who was out of form, bided his time before unfurling his repertoire of shots, then they also will be able to get runs against this quartet,



A missed opportunity: Hardly any bouncers were bowled to Travis Head during his first 30 deliveries in Brisbane while he was trying to settle in. GETTYIMAGES

who have more than 500 wickets between them.

Lots of patience and self-belief are needed, and some shots need to be put in cold storage till the batter is well set. Easier said than done, of course, but try it, and maybe you will find it can be done.



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